

THORNBILLS AND RELATIVES

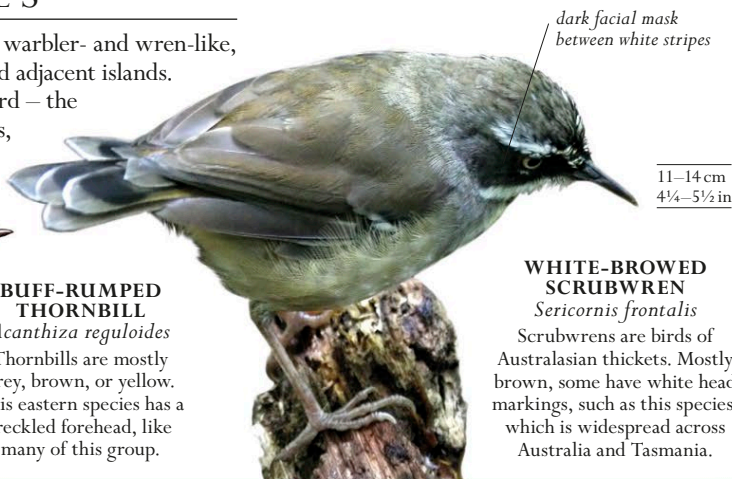
The Acanthizidae is a small family of warbler- and wren-like, insect-eating birds from Australia and adjacent islands. It also includes Australia's smallest bird – the weebill. These birds have short wings, a short tail, and drab-coloured, longish legs.



11 cm
4 1/4 in

BUFF-RUMPED THORNBILL

Acanthiza reguloides
Thornbills are mostly grey, brown, or yellow. This eastern species has a freckled forehead, like many of this group.



dark facial mask
between white stripes

11–14 cm
4 1/4–5 1/2 in

WHITE-BROWED SCRUBWREN

Sericornis frontalis
Scrubwrens are birds of Australasian thickets. Mostly brown, some have white head markings, such as this species, which is widespread across Australia and Tasmania.

PARDALOTES

Dumpy birds from Australia, the Pardalotidae have a stubby bill for gleaning sap-sucking scale insects from trees. Brightly coloured, they nest in deep tunnels in earth banks.



8–10 cm
3 1/4–4 in

SPOTTED PARDALOTE

Pardalotus punctatus
Three of the four species of pardalotes have white spots. This highly active bird is from dry forests in S. and E. Australia.

WOODSWALLOWS, BUTCHERBIRDS, AND RELATIVES

From Southeast Asia, New Guinea, and Australasia, the birds in the family Artamidae include woodswallows that catch insects in flight and are among the few small passerines that can soar. The Australasian butcherbirds, currawongs, and ground-dwelling Australian magpies are intelligent, highly vocal, omnivorous birds.



19 cm
7 1/2 in

MASKED WOODSWALLOW

Artamus personatus
This dark-faced, thick-billed woodswallow occurs in drier parts of inland Australia and is highly nomadic. Like other woodswallows, it often gathers in large flocks.



AUSTRALIAN MAGPIE

Gymnorhina tibicen
A widespread Australian species with a highly variable black and white plumage, this bird has a varied and melodious song and is a capable mimic.

34–44 cm
13 1/2–17 1/2 in

IORAS

These rainforest birds, the Aegithinidae, are usually active in the high canopy. Their green or yellow coloration camouflages them in foliage, where they glean for insects. Males can engage in elaborate courtship displays.



15 cm
6 in

COMMON IORA

Aegithina tiphia
The smallest and most widespread iora, it is found across tropical Asia, from India to Borneo, sometimes in disturbed habitats. This bird builds a cup-shaped nest.

CROWS AND JAYS

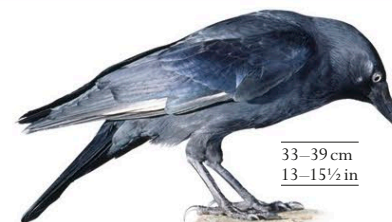
The family Corvidae, occurring worldwide, includes some of the biggest passerines. They are intelligent, opportunistic birds that have complex social organization and strong pair-bonding. Crows have demonstrated tool use, play behaviour, and perhaps even self-awareness.



56–69 cm
22–27 in

COMMON RAVEN

Corvus corax
Found in a wide range of open-country habitats across the northern hemisphere, this is the most widespread crow and the largest passerine.



33–39 cm
13–15 1/2 in

EURASIAN JACKDAW

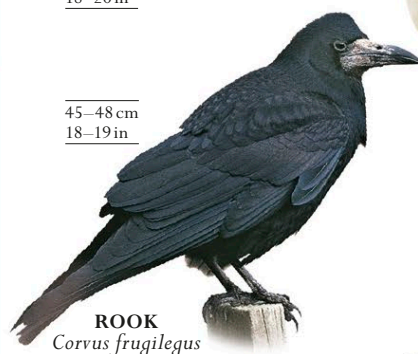
Corvus monedula
A small crow of W. Eurasia and N. Africa, this bird nests in cavities on crags, and is found on coastal cliffs and in urban areas.



PIED CROW

Corvus albus
A relative of the raven, this heavy-billed bird of open country is perhaps the commonest member of the crow family in Africa and Madagascar.

46–50 cm
18–20 in



45–48 cm
18–19 in

ROOK

Corvus frugilegus
Routinely flocking throughout the year in Eurasia, this bare-faced crow nests in colonies in trees in open countryside.



47–52 cm
18 1/2–20 1/2 in

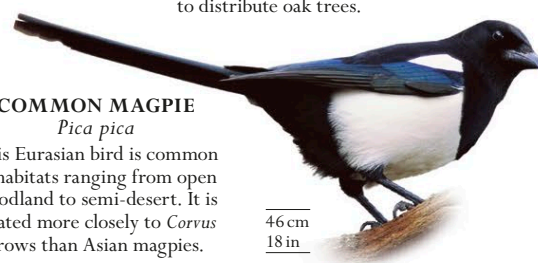
CARRION CROW

Corvus corone
This common Eurasian, largely solitary species has a wide-ranging diet. It feeds on small animals and vegetable matter, as well as carrion.

COMMON MAGPIE

Pica pica
This Eurasian bird is common in habitats ranging from open woodland to semi-desert. It is related more closely to *Corvus* crows than Asian magpies.

46 cm
18 in



BLUE JAY

Cyanocitta cristata
This colourful jay of N. America lives in tightly bonded family groups. It is fond of acorns and disperses them, helping to distribute oak trees.

25–30 cm
10–12 in



very long tail